

Career Project Elaboration

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Class details

- 12h: 2h*6
- Grade: Participation (30%)+CV (30% Session 4) +pitch (30% Session 5)+recruiter game (10% Session 6)

Syllabus

- Session 1:**

Who are you? list your strength, values, goals, long term goals too

- Session 2**

Class on French CV, difference, work on your CV

- Session 3**

Work on LinkedIn, where to find a job, where to look

- Session 4**

Score anonymous CV, explain why you select this CV

- Session 5**

Work on your elevator pitch, storytelling. Grade other

- Session 6:**

Recruiter game, mock interviews in group.

Who are you? list your strength, values,
goals, long term goals too

Session 1

Who are you? list your strength, values, goals, long term goals too

Session 1

OBJECTIVES

- Identify your own technical and soft skills.
- Explore personal values and how they align with career goals.
- Define your short- and long-term career objectives.

Who are you?

The most important person in your career: *you*.

Before you write a CV, go on LinkedIn, or apply for jobs, you need to **know your own strengths, values, and goals.**

Technical Skills vs Soft Skills

What are the main differences between soft skills and hard skills?

Soft skills are personal attributes that influence how you work and interact with others. They include communication, teamwork, adaptability, problem-solving, and leadership. Hard skills, on the other hand, are specific, teachable abilities that are typically job-related. Examples include programming languages, data analysis, and technical certifications. In a job context, hard skills are often easier to quantify, while soft skills are crucial for workplace dynamics and collaboration.

Technical Skills vs Soft Skills

Technical skills (savoir-faire) = what you do, measurable abilities (e.g., Python, Excel, statistics)

Soft skills (savoir-être) = how you *behave*, Interpersonal strengths (e.g., empathy, communication)

Employers want both! : While technical skills are essential to perform specific tasks, soft skills are what enable you to work effectively in teams, communicate ideas clearly, solve problems creatively, and lead or adapt to changes. Employers value IT professionals who can not only code but also collaborate, communicate with clients, and work well under pressure.

Technical Skills vs Soft Skills

- Coding
- Empathy
- Time management
- Data visualization
- Negotiation
- SQL
- Teamwork
- Creativity

Technical Skills vs Soft Skills

Skill

Coding

Empathy

Time management

Data visualization

Negotiation

SQL

Teamwork

Creativity

Type

Technical (savoir-faire)

Soft (savoir-être)

Soft (savoir-être)

Technical (savoir-faire)

Soft (savoir-être)

Technical (savoir-faire)

Soft (savoir-être)

Soft (savoir-être)

Soft Skills

- **Communication** – Express ideas clearly and adapt to different audiences.
- **Teamwork** – Collaborate effectively to reach shared goals.
- **Problem-solving** – Identify issues and develop creative solutions.
- **Time management** – Prioritize tasks and meet deadlines efficiently.
- **Leadership** – Inspire, guide, and motivate others.
- **Adaptability** – Adjust easily to new situations and changes.
- **Creativity** – Generate new ideas and think outside the box.
- **Empathy** – Understand and connect with others' emotions.
- **Conflict resolution** – Manage and resolve disagreements constructively.
- **Active listening** – Focus fully on the speaker's message.
- **Critical thinking** – Analyze information objectively and logically.
- **Cultural competence** – Work effectively across diverse cultures.
- **Customer service** – Provide helpful, professional, and timely support.
- **Decision-making** – Make informed, timely, and accountable choices.
- **Emotional intelligence** – Manage your emotions and understand others.
- **Flexibility** – Handle multiple tasks and shifting priorities.
- **Goal-setting** – Define and pursue clear, achievable objectives.
- **Interpersonal skills** – Build and maintain positive relationships.
- **Negotiation** – Find win-win agreements through persuasion.
- **Patience** – Stay calm and composed under pressure.
- **Persuasion** – Convince others with strong arguments and trust.
- **Positive attitude** – Stay optimistic and solution-oriented.
- **Presentation skills** – Deliver ideas clearly and engagingly.
- **Problem analysis** – Identify root causes and evaluate solutions.
- **Self-motivation** – Stay driven without external pressure.
- **Stress management** – Remain effective under pressure.
- **Trustworthiness** – Be reliable, honest, and accountable.
- **Verbal communication** – Speak clearly and adapt to listeners.
- **Writing** – Convey ideas clearly in written form.
- **Attention to detail** – Ensure accuracy and high-quality results.
- **Coaching & mentoring** – Guide others' growth and development.
- **Conflict management** – Handle disputes to promote collaboration.
- **Cultural awareness** – Respect and understand cultural differences.
- **Dependability** – Be consistent, punctual, and reliable.
- **Diversity & inclusion** – Value and integrate different perspectives.
- **Enthusiasm** – Approach work with energy and passion.
- **Financial management** – Use financial resources wisely.
- **Humility** – Admit mistakes and learn from feedback.
- **Initiative** – Take proactive steps to improve outcomes.
- **Innovation** – Create new ideas, products, or processes.
- **Intercultural communication** – Communicate effectively across cultures.
- **Interpersonal communication** – Use empathy and non-verbal cues to connect.
- **Learning agility** – Learn quickly and adapt to change.
- **Organizational skills** – Manage time, tasks, and priorities well.
- **Presentation (advanced)** – Deliver persuasive and credible presentations.
- **Resilience** – Recover quickly from setbacks.
- **Strategic thinking** – Plan ahead and anticipate challenges.
- **Work ethic** – Show persistence and commitment to work.
- **Collaboration** – Share resources and ideas effectively in teams.
- **Professionalism** – Maintain integrity, respect, and responsibility.

Hard Skills

- **Software Engineering**
 - Programming languages (Python, Java, C++, C#)
 - Software design & architecture
 - Version control (Git, GitHub, GitLab)
 - Testing & debugging
- **Databases & Data Science**
 - SQL (MySQL, PostgreSQL, Oracle)
 - NoSQL (MongoDB, Cassandra)
 - Data analysis & visualization (Pandas, Matplotlib, Power BI)
 - Machine Learning (scikit-learn, TensorFlow, PyTorch)
- **Web Development**
 - HTML, CSS, JavaScript
 - Frameworks (React, Angular, Vue.js)
 - Backend (Node.js, Django, Flask)
 - REST APIs & GraphQL
- **Systems & Cybersecurity**
 - Linux/Unix system administration
 - Networking protocols (TCP/IP, DNS, HTTP)
 - Cybersecurity basics (firewalls, IDS/IPS, encryption)
 - Penetration testing & ethical hacking
- **Artificial Intelligence**
 - Deep Learning (CNNs, RNNs, Transformers)
 - Natural Language Processing (NLP)
 - Computer Vision (OpenCV, YOLO)
 - Reinforcement Learning

Skills

How do I know what skills to focus on for my job search?

Start by researching the job descriptions for positions you're interested in. Look for common skills that appear frequently in those listings. This will give you an idea of what employers are looking for.

Focus on building both your hard skills relevant to the role (e.g., programming languages, software tools) and soft skills (e.g., communication, problem-solving) that complement your technical expertise.

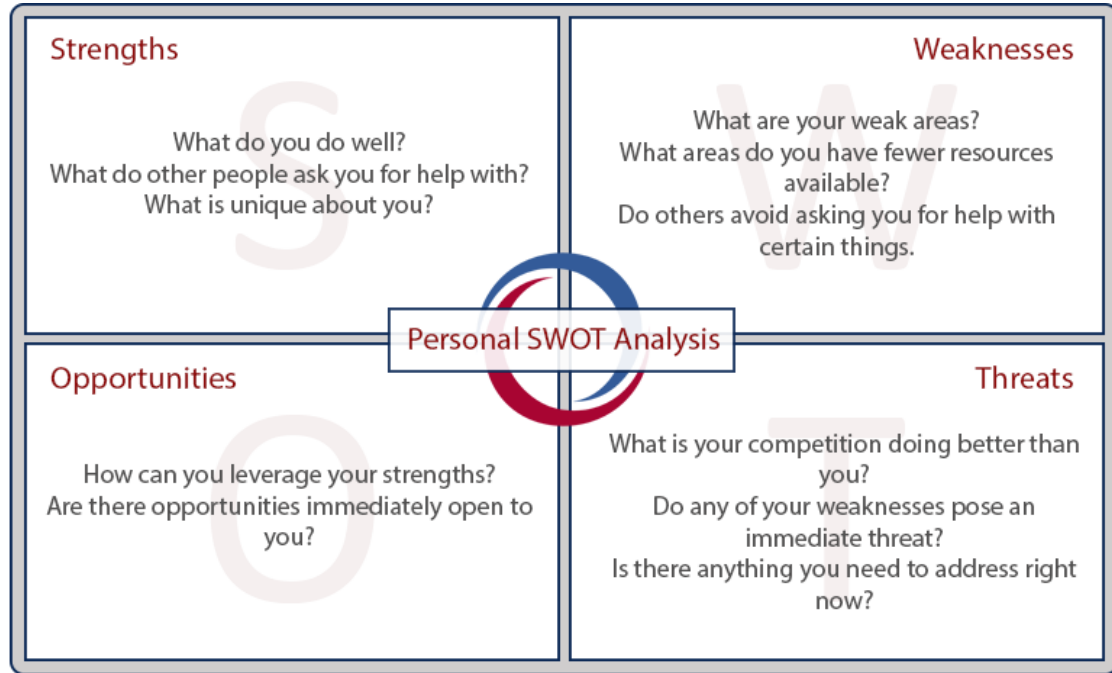
What Are Your Strengths?

- **Think about compliments you've received**
- **What activities energize you?**
- **What comes naturally?**

What Are Your Values?

- **Values = principles that guide decisions**
- **Examples: Honesty, Respect, Curiosity, Freedom, Ambition**
- **What drives your best work?**
- **Included in soft skills**

SWOT analysis



Covenant
HEALTH



Setting Career Goals

- **Define short- and long-term goals**
 - What do you want to achieve in the next 6–12 months?
 - What is your vision in 3–5 years?
- **Use SMART method:**
 - Specific
 - Measurable
 - Achievable
 - Relevant
 - Time-bound



Your turn

Be honest with yourself.

List your:

- **Soft skills**
- **Hard skills**

At least 5 each and justify them with examples.

- Complete:
 - **SWOT analysis**
- 5-Year Vision Statement
 - **Draft 3 SMART goals**

Crafting a French CV

Session 2

Crafting a French CV

Session 2

OBJECTIVES

- Understand the structure and cultural norms of a French CV
- Learn the purpose of each section (Header, Profile, Skills, Experience, etc.)
- Identify and avoid common mistakes

CV Structure Overview

1-page rule (even for experienced candidates)

Clean, minimal layout

Optional photo

A professional font (Times New Roman, Georgia, Arial, Cambria, Calibri, Helvetica)

A font size between 10 and 12 points for regular text and 14 and 16 points for headers

margins of 2.5 cm on all sides (1.5 cm minimum at the bottom)

- **Header**
- **Professional profile (Profil)**
- **Skills (Savoir être et savoir-faire)**
- **Experience (Expériences professionnelles)**
- **Education (Formation)**
- **Optional: Certifications, Languages, Interests (Centres d'intérêt)**

HEADER

Name (in bold)

Phone number (French format)

Email address (professional!)

LinkedIn link or portfolio

Address (City at least). If you live in Paris and apply in Toulouse, mention that you can move

Title

Do not include:

- Age
- Nationality
- Marital status

Mistake to avoid

- Using personal/unprofessional email (e.g. pinkprincess@gmail.com)

Photo?

There is no set rule to using a photo on your resume, and it remains optional (to avoid unlawful discrimination).

If you want to do it:

Placement: Place your photo in the top right or left corner of your CV.

Size: Use a small, passport-sized photo (typically 3.5 x 4.5 cm).

Attire: Dress professionally in business attire suitable for your industry. Avoid casual clothing.

Background: Opt for a neutral background, avoiding any busy or distracting elements.

Expression: A friendly, neutral expression is ideal. Extreme expressions are best avoided.

Quality: Ensure that your photo is clear, well-lit, and of good resolution. A blurry or poorly lit image can impact the perception of your professionalism.

Profile

This is your elevator pitch in writing. Say clearly who you are, what you're good at, and what you want. Keep it short and powerful

Who you are professionally

2–3 key achievements or qualities

Your goal (what type of role/sector you target)

Common Mistakes:

- Being too vague (“Motivated student looking for a job”)
- Writing in the third person

Fort de 3 années d'expérience en Data Science et d'un doctorat en statistiques appliquées, je maîtrise l'ensemble de la chaîne de traitement des données, du nettoyage à la modélisation prédictive. Mon expertise en machine learning et ma capacité à vulgariser des concepts complexes m'ont permis de générer une augmentation moyenne de 25% des performances des modèles déployés. Je recherche un nouveau challenge où je pourrai mettre mes compétences analytiques au service de projets innovants.

Skills

Soft Skills (Savoir-être) and hard skills (savoir faire)

Avoid clichés and empty phrases

Avoid phrases such as "hard worker", "team player" or "strong leadership". Instead, use concrete examples to demonstrate your skills and achievements. For example, instead of saying "good communication skills", you could mention that you led presentations in front of groups of 50 people at your previous job.

Avoid start sliders for your skill level

Sliders and star ratings to indicate your skill are increasingly popular. However, simply showing '3 stars' in Excel doesn't tell recruiters what you can actually do. Much like using icons, this approach misses the chance to be specific — and to effectively highlight your expertise

Experience

- **Reverse chronological order**
- **Each entry: Job title, company, city, dates**
- **2–4 bullet points with actions + impact**
- **Personalize your experiences as much as possible with results (amounts, percentages, volumes, frequencies, etc.) that will illustrate your experience. This is the only way to truly differentiate yourself.**

Common Mistakes:

- Writing job descriptions instead of achievements
- Using the present tense for past jobs
- List irrelevant experience for this job (e.g. pizza delivery...)

Data Scientist Junior StartupData, Paris [MM/AA] - [MM/AA]

- Analyse des comportements clients via des algorithmes de clustering
- Développement d'un modèle de prédiction des ventes avec une précision de 89%
- Collaboration avec les équipes marketing pour l'optimisation des campagnes

Education/certification

Name of the formation

Date

University/School

No need to mention all your degrees.

Never put it before your experiences!!

FORMATION

Doctorat en Statistiques Appliquées - [MM/AA] - [MM/AA]

Université Paris-Saclay

Thèse : "Applications du Deep Learning aux séries temporelles"

Master en Data Science - [MM/AA] - [MM/AA]

École Polytechnique

Languages

Use clear wording for language levels (e.g., “Intermediate B2” instead of vague terms).

Avoid bars, stars, or percentages — they look nice but lack meaning.

LANGUES

- Français (Langue maternelle)
- Anglais (Courant - C1)
- Allemand (Intermédiaire - B1)

Interest

Personalize: hiking in the Alps > “sports”

Choose 2–3 max

Can highlight leadership, curiosity, creativity

Common Mistake:

Writing generic, boring terms: “reading, music, sports”

BAD CV

Content: ✗ Frequent Errors:

- Too long
- Generic and not tailored to the job. Same CV for 50 different jobs...
- Only lists duties, not accomplishments
- Unprofessional email address
- Dense or chaotic formatting
- No keywords → rejected by ATS
- A CV should be easy to read. Avoid fancy fonts or colours that might distract from the content. Stick to a clean, professional design with clear headings and bullet points.

✓ How to Fix It:

- Highlight measurable impact with numbers and action verbs
- Customize each CV to match the job offer (skills, summary, wording)
- Use clear, clean formatting (1 font, section titles)
- Focus on achievements, not just responsibilities

spelling mistakes and grammatical errors

Your turn

Work on your CV

LinkedIn & Job Search Strategy

Session 3

LinkedIn & Job Search Strategy

Session 3

OBJECTIVES

- Understand how to optimize a LinkedIn profile
- Know where and how to search for jobs effectively
- Create a compelling headline and summary

LinkedIn & Job Search Strategy

Session 3

OBJECTIVES

- Understand how to optimize a LinkedIn profile
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- Create a compelling headline and summary

Why LinkedIn Matters

90%+ of recruiters use LinkedIn to vet candidates

It's your digital CV, networking tool, and personal brand hub

Appears on the first page of Google when someone searches your name

LinkedIn Profile Essentials

- Professional profile photo
- Custom banner image
- Headline (not just your current title!)
- Summary section
- Work experience, education, skills, endorsements
- Headline
 - “Student at EPITA” → “**MSc Data Science Student | Passionate About Machine Learning & Sustainability**”
- Summary
 - Speak in first person
 - Tell a short professional story
 - Highlight 2–3 key achievements or passions
 - End with a call to action (e.g., open to internships in X field)

LinkedIn profile review :

<https://resumeworded.com/linkedin-review/upload-linkedin>

Job Search Strategy

- **Match the platform with your career goals and field.**
- **Diversify your search across multiple platform**
- **Stay consistent and professional in your applications.**

Licorne Society



Licorne Society

Jobs

Recruteurs

Ressources

Connexion

Inscription

Recrutement en startup et digital

**La seule plateforme des jobs en
startup et dans le digital.**

Accède à toutes les opportunités du marché et rends ton profil visible des meilleures startups et entreprises recrutant sur des postes digitaux.

Trouve ton prochain job

Je recrute



Choco
Head of sales
Paris 80k-120k€





Swile
Marketing Manager
Remote 55k-66k€





Jobteaser
Chief of Staff
Paris 80k-90k€



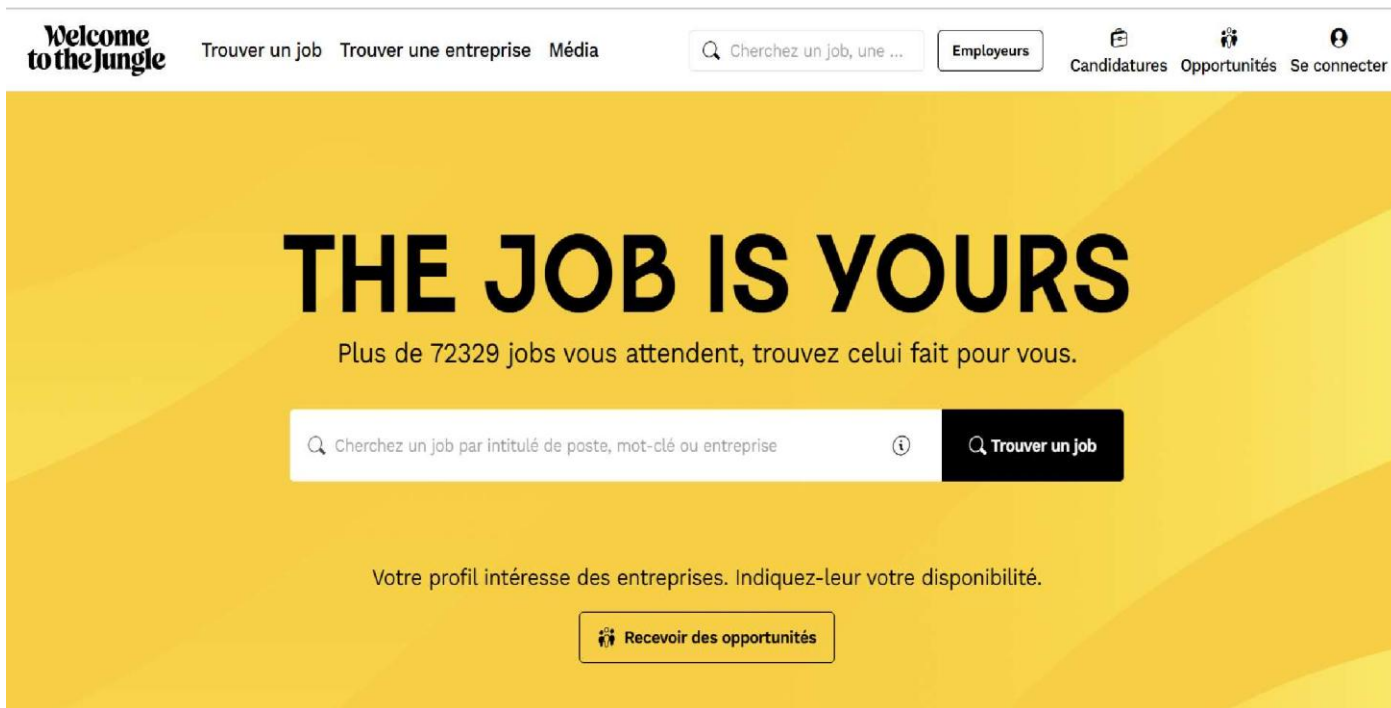


LaCollection
Operations Manager
Paris 60k-80k€



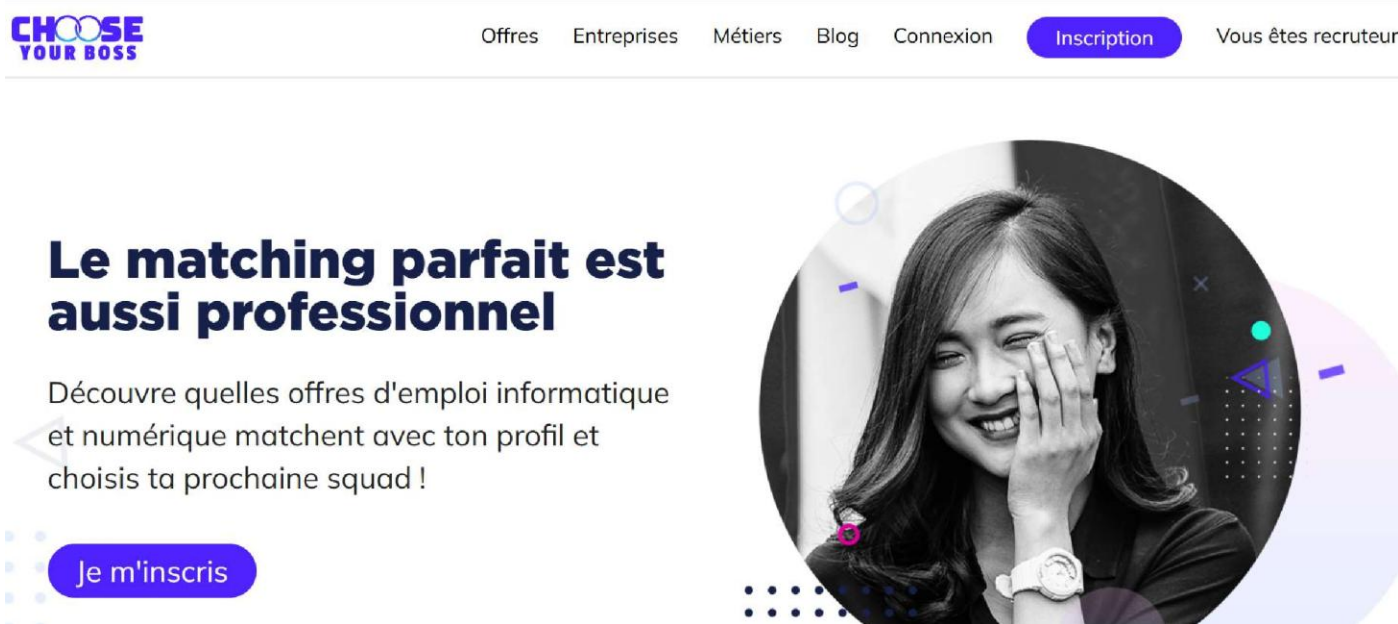
- **Positioning:** Focused on digital and startup jobs in France
- **Market Presence:** Over 8,000 job opportunities across tech, sales, marketing, and product roles.
- **Specific Features:** AI-driven job matching, confidentiality for job seekers, and direct recruiter outreach options.

Welcome to the Jungle



- **Positioning:** Comprehensive job board showcasing company culture.
- **Market Presence:** Popular among students and young professionals in Europe.
- **Specific Features:** Rich multimedia profiles for companies, career advice, and insights.

Choose your boss



The screenshot shows the homepage of the 'CHOOSE YOUR BOSS' website. At the top, there is a navigation bar with the logo on the left and links for 'Offres', 'Entreprises', 'Métiers', 'Blog', 'Connexion', 'Inscription' (highlighted in a blue button), and 'Vous êtes recruteur'. The main content area features a large headline 'Le matching parfait est aussi professionnel' in bold dark blue text. Below it, a sub-headline reads 'Découvre quelles offres d'emploi informatique et numérique matchent avec ton profil et choisis ta prochaine squad !'. A blue button labeled 'Je m'inscris' is positioned to the left of a large circular image of a smiling woman with long dark hair, wearing a white watch. The image is decorated with colorful geometric shapes like circles, triangles, and lines. To the left of the image, there are decorative elements including a light blue arrow pointing left and a grid of small dots.

CHOOSE YOUR BOSS

Offres Entreprises Métiers Blog Connexion **Inscription** Vous êtes recruteur

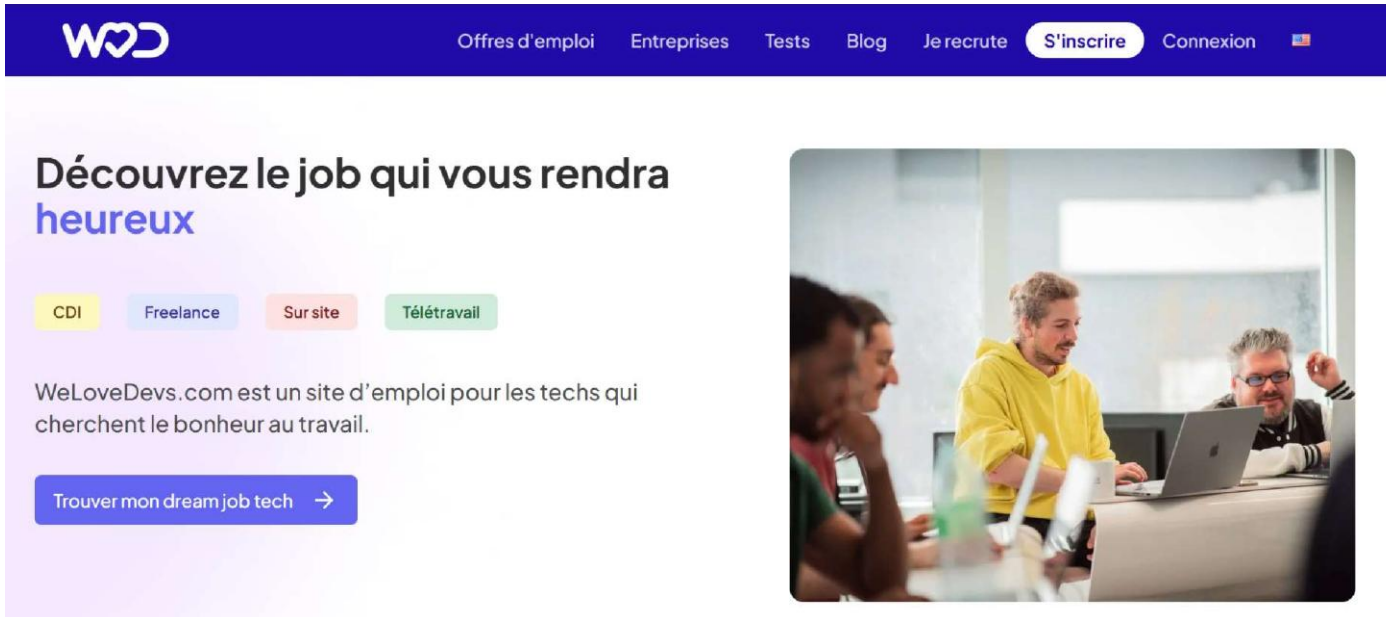
Le matching parfait est aussi professionnel

Découvre quelles offres d'emploi informatique et numérique matchent avec ton profil et choisis ta prochaine squad !

Je m'inscris

- **Positioning:** Specialized in IT and tech jobs.
- **Market Presence:** Recognized platform for tech talents in France.
- **Specific Features:** Candidates remain anonymous until they choose to apply.

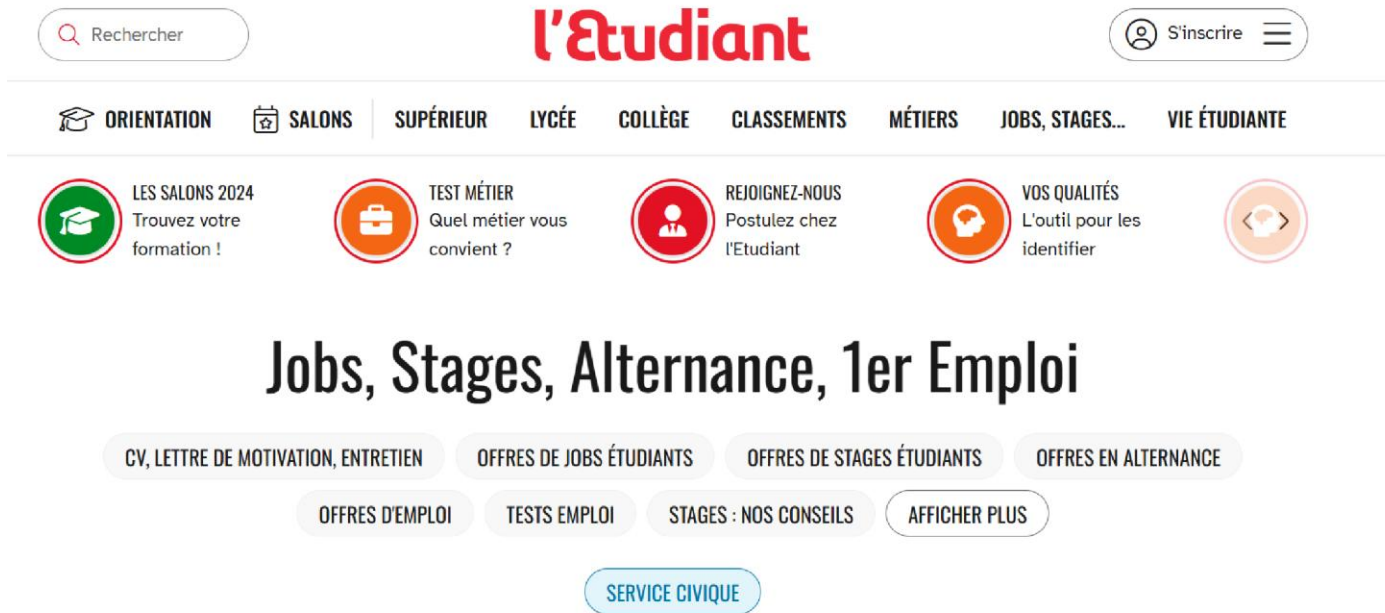
We love devs



The screenshot shows the homepage of WeLoveDevs.com. At the top is a dark blue navigation bar with the WLD logo on the left and links for 'Offres d'emploi', 'Entreprises', 'Tests', 'Blog', 'Je recrute', 'S'inscrire' (highlighted in a white pill button), and 'Connexion' on the right. Below the navigation bar, the main heading reads 'Découvrez le job qui vous rendra heureux' in a mix of black and blue text. Underneath are four colored buttons: 'CDI' (yellow), 'Freelance' (light blue), 'Sur site' (light red), and 'Télétravail' (light green). A paragraph states: 'WeLoveDevs.com est un site d'emploi pour les techs qui cherchent le bonheur au travail.' At the bottom of this section is a blue button with the text 'Trouver mon dream job tech' and a right-pointing arrow. To the right of the text area is a photograph of three people in a modern office setting, with one person in a yellow hoodie working on a laptop.

- **Positioning:** Designed for developers and tech enthusiasts.
- **Market Presence:** Niche platform focused on matching developers with companies.
- **Specific Features:** Emphasis on company culture and developer values.

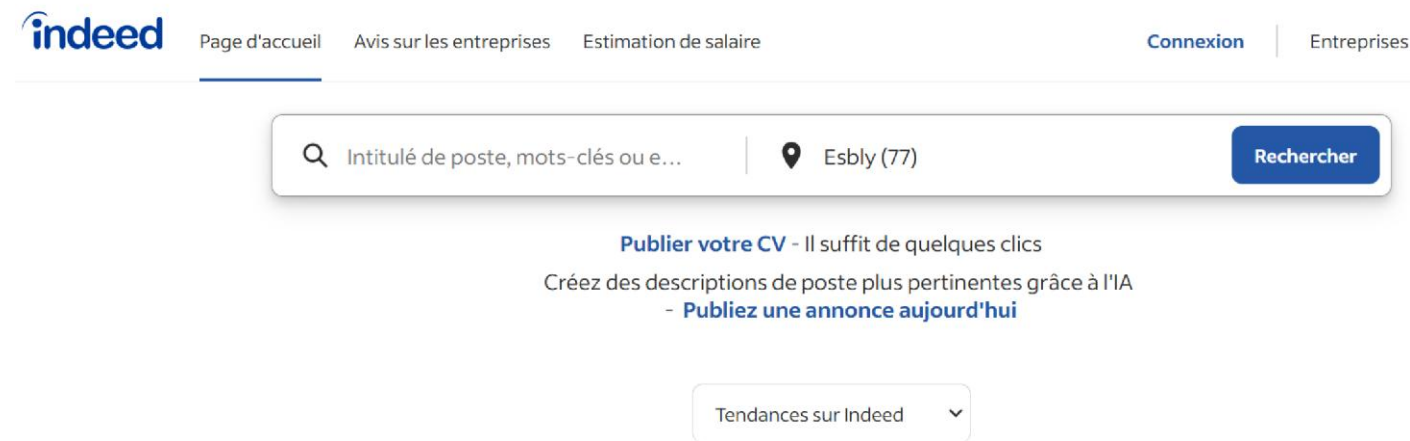
L'Etudiant



Trouvez votre job

- **Positioning:** General platform for students and young graduates.
- **Market Presence:** One of the most visited websites for internships and student advice in France.
- **Specific Features:** Covers internships, apprenticeships, and first jobs.

Indeed



The screenshot shows the Indeed homepage. At the top left is the Indeed logo. To its right are navigation links: "Page d'accueil", "Avis sur les entreprises", and "Estimation de salaire". Further right are "Connexion" and "Entreprises". Below the navigation bar is a large search bar. The search bar has a magnifying glass icon on the left, followed by the placeholder text "Intitulé de poste, mots-clés ou e...". To the right of the text is a location pin icon followed by "Esbly (77)". To the far right of the search bar is a blue button labeled "Rechercher". Below the search bar, there is a promotional message: "Publier votre CV - Il suffit de quelques clics", followed by "Créez des descriptions de poste plus pertinentes grâce à l'IA", and then "- Publiez une annonce aujourd'hui". At the bottom of the visible area, there is a dropdown menu labeled "Tendances sur Indeed" with a downward arrow.

- **Positioning:** General job board for all industries.
- **Market Presence:** One of the largest job boards globally, including France.
- **Specific Features:** Aggregates job listings from thousands of sources.

Talent.io

talent.io

Candidates ▾

Recruiters ▾

Resources ▾

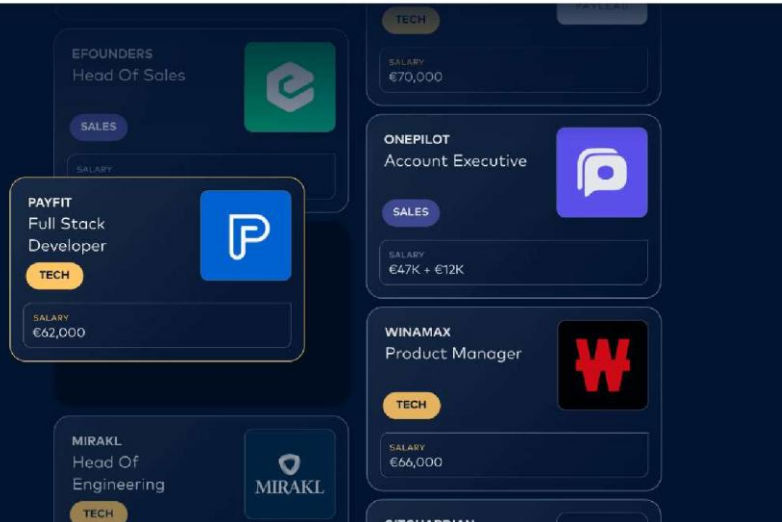
EN ▾

Login

Sign up

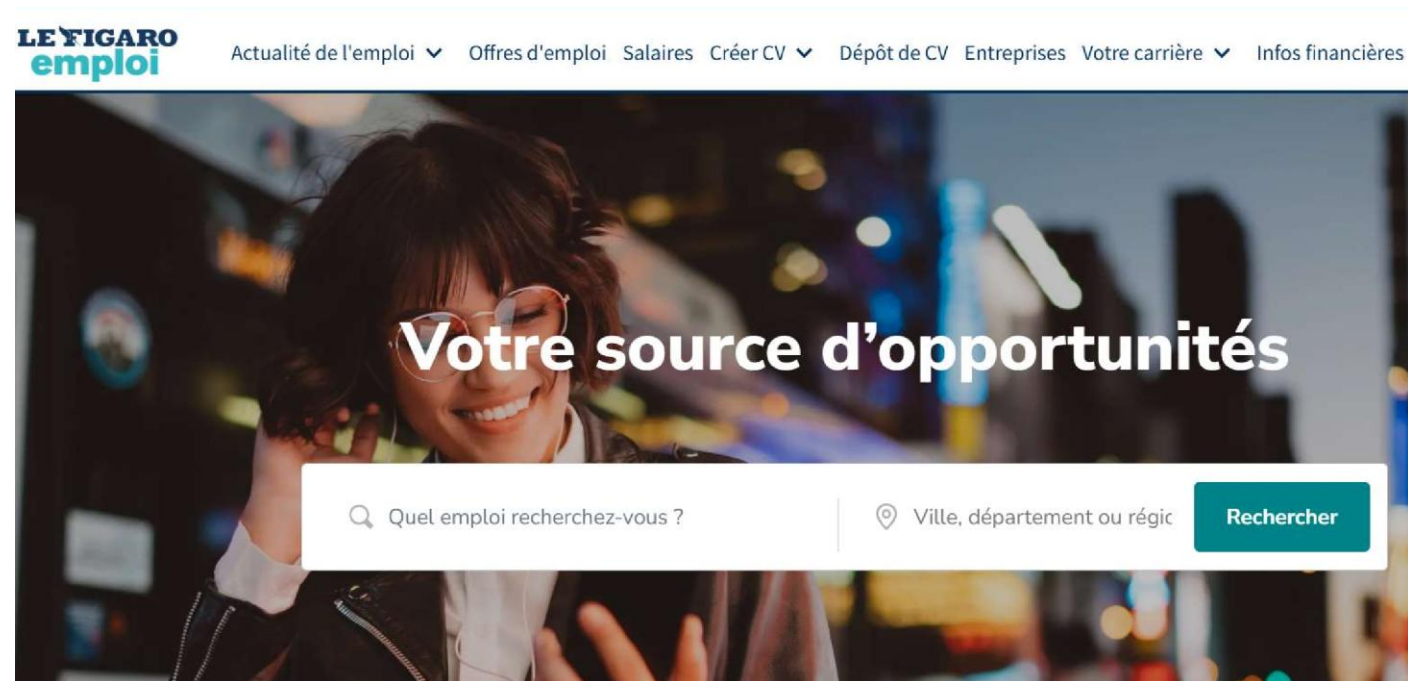
Find **your next**
job in a tech
company in 1
month

Dev Data Sales Product



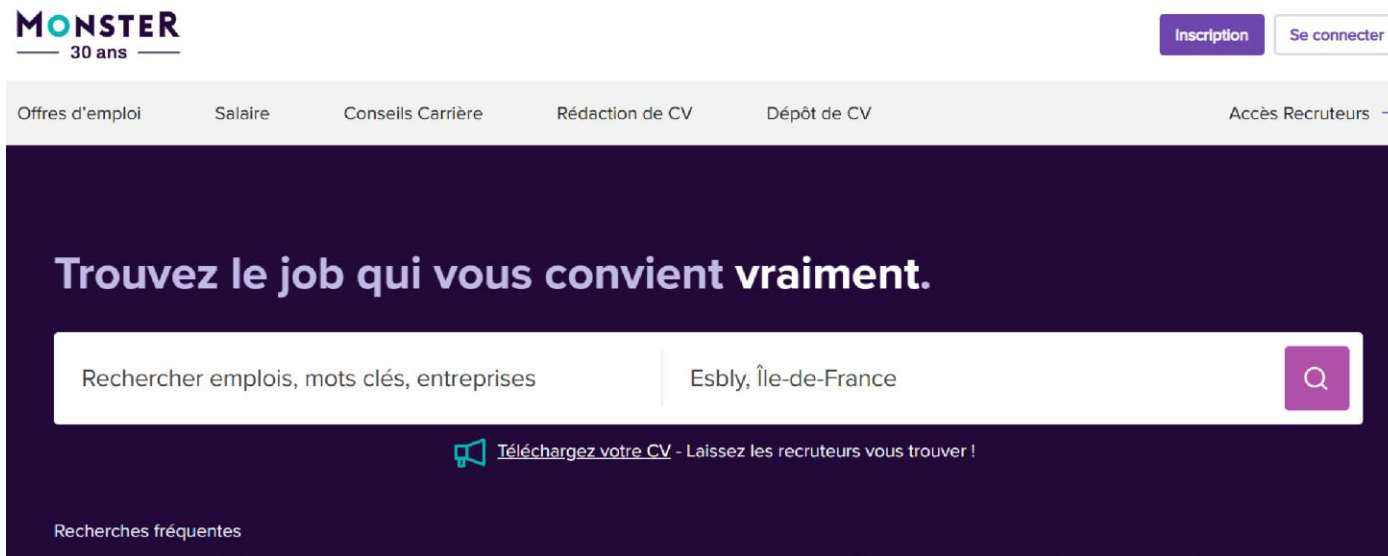
- **Positioning:** A selective platform for tech jobs.
- **Market Presence:** Trusted by leading tech companies in Europe.
- **Specific Features:** Simplifies hiring by directly connecting companies with pre-screened candidates.

Keljob.com (le Figaro)



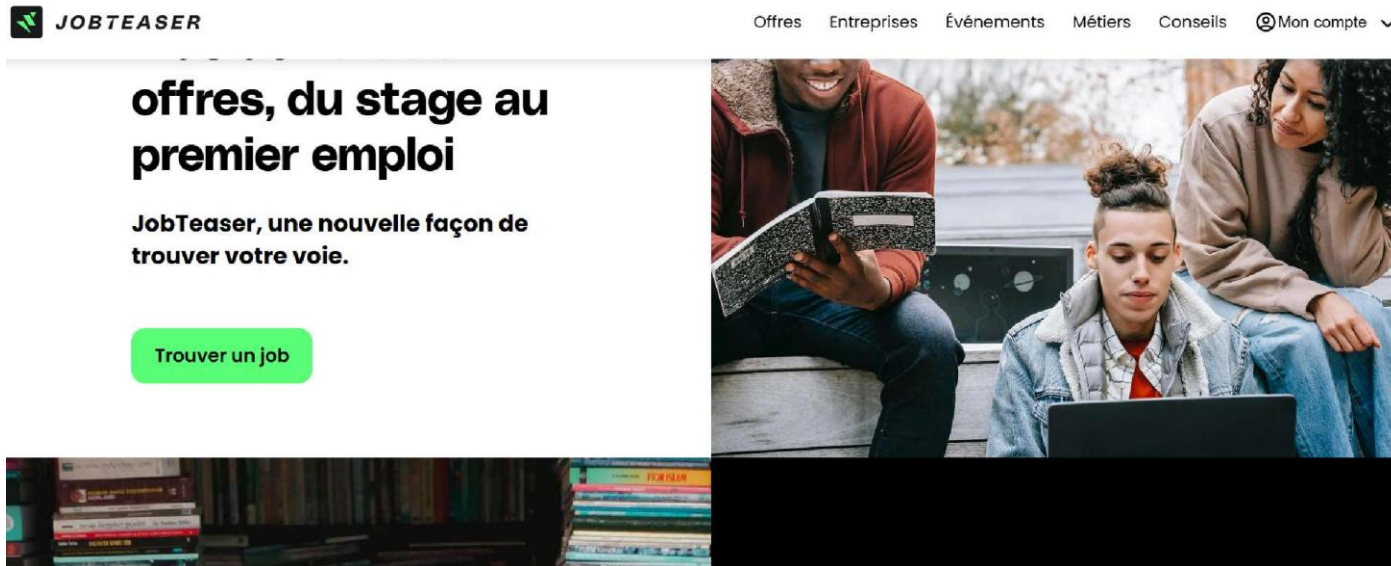
- **Positioning:** General job board for various industries.
- **Market Presence:** A major player in the French market.
- **Specific Features:** Offers personalized job recommendations and career advice.

Monster.fr



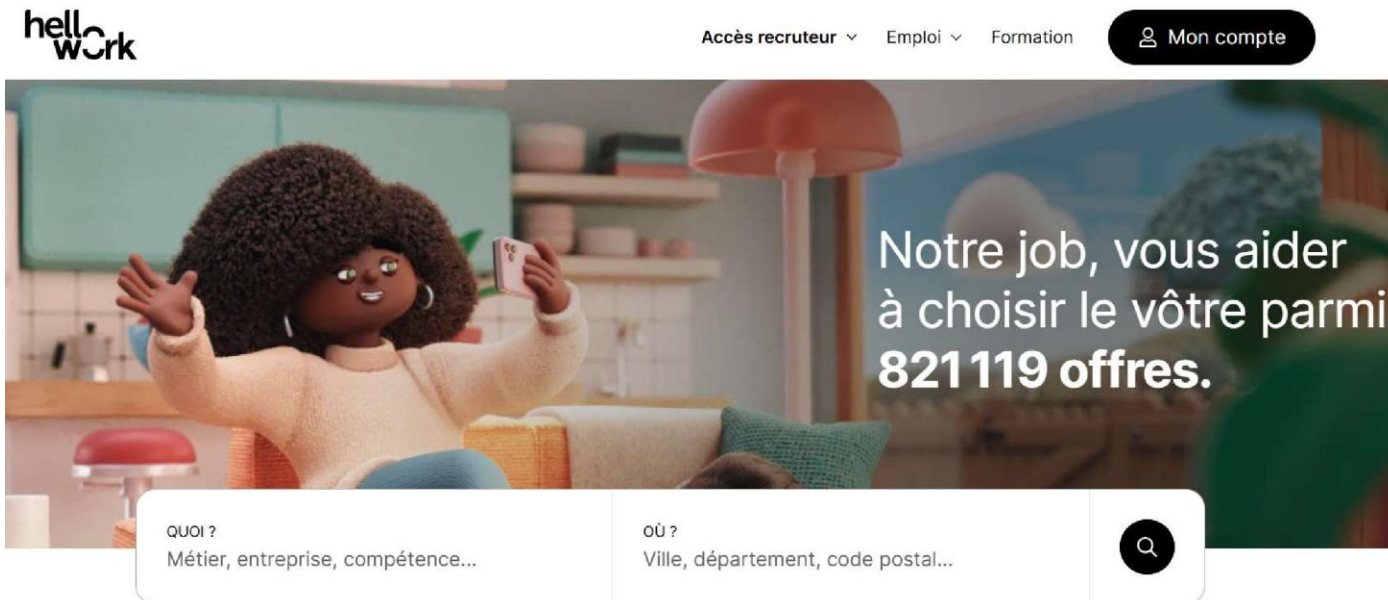
- **Positioning:** General job board for various industries.
- **Market Presence:** A major player in the French market.
- **Specific Features:** Offers personalized job recommendations and career advice.

Jobteaser.com



- **Positioning:** Tailored for students and universities.
- **Market Presence:** Collaborates with schools and universities across Europe.
- **Specific Features:** Includes exclusive job offers for partnered institutions

Hellowork



- **Positioning:** Grouping of several regional sites.
- **Market Presence:** Known for helping students find their first professional experiences.
- **Specific Features:** Focus on internships and early-career roles.

Activity

- **Work on your linkedin profile:** Draft Your Headline + Summary. Ask review from your friends, work in group!!

[The Ultimate Guide To Crafting A LinkedIn Profile That Recruiters Love](#)

- **LinkedIn profile review :**

<https://resumeworded.com/linkedin-review/upload-linkedin>

- **Explore job platforms find a job your want to apply. Your will HAVE TO BRING YOUR UPDATED CV FOR THIS JOB FOR NEXT SESSION**

Recruiter Lens – CV Scoring

Session 4

OBJECTIVES

- Understand how recruiters scan CVs
- Apply a scoring rubric to anonymized CVs
- Reflect on what makes a CV stand out

What Recruiters Actually Do

- **7–10 seconds average scan time on first read**
- **100+ CVs per role**
- **Focus on keywords, layout, impact, clarity**

The 7-Second Scan Checklist

- **Is the layout clean and easy to scan?**
- **Are keywords from the job description visible?**
- **Is the profile clear and targeted?**
- **Are achievements measurable?**
- **Are there red?**
 - Typos and formatting errors
 - Gaps or frequent job-hopping (unexplained)
 - Vague buzzwords (“dynamic team player”)
 - No numbers, no impact

Recruiter Scoring Rubric (1–5 scale)

- **Relevance** **Fit with job offer and industry**
- **Clarity** **Clean layout, well-organized info**
- **Impact** **Use of metrics, action verbs, achievements**
- **Writing** **Spelling, grammar, precision**
- **Overall Fit** **Does this candidate deserve an interview?**

Activity

- **Students receive anonymized**
- **Small groups (depends on the class size) score each CV using the rubric**
- **Each group selects 1 winner and prepares 1-minute justification**

Elevator Pitch

Session 5

What is an Elevator Pitch?

- **A 30–60 second introduction (NO MORE!!!!)**
- **Your value proposition + personality**
- **Used in interviews, events, online profile**

Key Elements of a Good Pitch

- **Who you are**
- **What you've done** (key skills/achievements)
- **What you want** (your goal)

Be authentic, not robotic. Speak from the 'why' behind your journey. Keep it specific. DO NOT GO INTO TECHNICAL STORY, RECRUITER WILL ASK LATER

Example 1 – Student in Data Science: "Hi, I'm Sarah, a Master's student in Data Science with a background in economics. I've worked on projects using Python and machine learning to analyze consumer behavior. I'm currently looking for a data analyst internship in the sustainability sector."

Example 2 – Career Change to Tech: "Hi, I'm Alex. I spent five years in retail management, where I led teams and optimized workflows. Now I'm pivoting into tech and recently completed a full-stack web development bootcamp. I'm excited to join a startup where I can bring both leadership and coding skills."

Create your elevator pitch

Create your pitch in five steps

1. Spend some time thinking about and writing down your top work and school experiences using the STAR Method (Situation, Task, Action and Result). Choose one one-to-two experiences you want to pitch.
2. Shorten each story to a sentence or two focusing on your actions and the results of those actions.
3. Analyze the common themes:
 1. What are you good at?
 2. What do you like doing?
 3. Are you a problem solver, analytical thinker, effective communicator, innovator, etc?
4. Tailoring your pitch for the audience/person you are speaking to and the setting you are in
5. Put it together and make it conversational. Add a question to the end of your description or offer to help someone with something they are working on.

Hi, my name is Theo Tiger and I am a junior studying computer science at Epita.

I am interested in cybersecurity and web development because they challenge me to use my analytical skills to keep information secure. Last semester, I worked with a professor to develop a program that analyzed the psychological effects of social media on Twitter users. Right now I am looking for summer internship opportunities and I am interested in learning more about your company.

Can you tell me about the internship opportunities your company provides?

Create your elevator pitch

The Four-Step Elevator Pitch

1 Start by introducing yourself

"Hi, my name is Sara.
It's so nice to meet you!"

2 Provide a summary of what you do

"I'm a PR manager, specializing in overseeing successful initiative launches from beginning to end."

3 Explain what you want

"I find the work your PR team does to be innovating and refreshing — I'd love the opportunity to put my expertise to work for your company."

4 Finish with a call to action

"Would you mind if I set up a quick call next week for us to talk about any upcoming opportunities on your team?"

indeed
career guide

Tips for Delivery

- **Speak slowly, breathe, and smile**
- **Use your hands and eye contact**
- **Avoid memorizing word-for-word**
- **Rehearse out loud multiple times**

Elevator pitch

**PRINT AND BRING
YOUR CV FOR A JOB
YOU WANT APPLY FOR
NEXT SESSION**

Recruiter game

Session 6

OBJECTIVES

- Practice interview in groups

Most common interview questions

- **Tell me about yourself**
→ *Concise, relevant career story*
Sample Answer: “I’m a data scientist with 8 years of research experience in astronomy and machine learning. I’ve led international collaborations and supervised students, and now I’m looking to apply my analytical and leadership skills to data-driven projects in industry.”
- **Why do you want to work here?**
→ *Show company knowledge & enthusiasm*
Sample Answer: “I admire your company’s focus on innovation in AI and ethics. I see a strong alignment between my research in large-scale data analysis and your mission to develop impactful, responsible technology.”
- **Why should we hire you?**
→ *Prove value: skills, results, fit*
Sample Answer: “I bring a rare combination of technical expertise in machine learning and proven leadership from managing international research teams. I can deliver results quickly while also mentoring younger colleagues.”
- **What are your strengths?**
→ *Pick 1–2, give examples*
Sample Answer: “My main strengths are analytical problem-solving and adaptability. For example, during a project on time-series data, I developed a new method that improved classification accuracy by 20%.”
- **What is your greatest weakness?**
→ *Be honest, show improvement*
Sample Answer: “Earlier in my career, I sometimes focused too much on technical perfection. I’ve since learned to balance accuracy with efficiency, setting clear deadlines and priorities.”
- **Tell me about a challenge/conflict at work**
→ *Stay professional, focus on resolution*
Sample Answer: “In a collaboration, two teams disagreed on methodology. I facilitated a discussion, proposed a compromise using both approaches, and we published a joint paper that satisfied both sides.”
- **Why are you leaving your current job?**
→ *Keep it positive & future-focused*
Sample Answer: “I’ve enjoyed my research career, but I want to transition into a role where I can apply my expertise more directly to real-world challenges and contribute to innovation in industry.”
- **Where do you see yourself in 5 years?**
→ *Show ambition aligned with role*
Sample Answer: “In five years, I see myself leading a team of data scientists, contributing to both technical excellence and mentoring, while driving forward innovative projects in AI.”
- **Do you have any questions for us?**
→ *Prepare thoughtful questions*
Sample Answer: “Yes, I’d like to know how success is measured in this role after the first 6 months, and what opportunities exist for professional growth and cross-team collaboration.”

Most common interview questions

Tell me about a mistake → Admit, learn, correct, improve, grow

Tell me about a failure → Experience, reflection, resilience, growth, improvement

Why leaving current job? → Growth, opportunity, future, challenge, learning

Why were you fired? → Honest, lessons, growth, improved, ready

Why a career gap? → Personal, reasons, learning, ready, motivated

Why career change? → Skills, transferable, growth, interest, fit

Current salary? → Confidential, expectations, market, flexibility, discussion

What do you like least about your job? → Challenge, learning, growth, improvement, positive

What do you want in a new role? → Challenge, growth, learning, impact, opportunity

Preferred work environment? → Collaborative, innovative, flexible, respectful, supportive

Describe your work style → Organized, collaborative, proactive, adaptable, reliable

Describe your management style → Supportive, clear, collaborative, flexible, motivating

How would your boss describe you? → Reliable, dedicated, collaborative, skilled, professional

How would coworkers describe you? → Team-player, helpful, adaptable, reliable, friendly

How do you handle stress/pressure? → Planning, focus, prioritization, calm, resilience

What do you like to do outside work? → Hobbies, balance, interests, healthy, creative

How do you stay organized? → Tools, planning, lists, priorities, efficiency

How do you prioritize work? → Urgency, importance, deadlines, balance, efficiency

What are you passionate about? → Learning, innovation, challenges, impact, growth

What motivates you? → Challenges, results, growth, learning, impact

Pet peeves? → Negativity, disorganization, lateness, inefficiency, dishonesty

Preferred management style? → Supportive, transparent, empowering, respectful, clear

Do you consider yourself successful? → Yes, achievements, growth, recognition, goals

Where do you see yourself in 5 years? → Leadership, growth, mentoring, contribution, impact

- **What are your career goals?** → Progression, expertise, leadership, growth, contribution
- **What are your career aspirations?** → Growth, leadership, impact, innovation, success
- **What is your dream job?** → Challenge, passion, impact, growth, leadership
- **Other companies you're interviewing with?** → Confidential, general, similar, interest, options
- **What makes you unique?** → Skills, perspective, adaptability, results, creativity
- **What's not on your resume?** → Personality, skills, values, passions, experiences
- **First 3 months in role?** → Learn, adapt, contribute, collaborate, plan
- **Salary expectations?** → Flexible, market, range, negotiable, open
- **What could we do better?** → Respectful, constructive, improvement, opportunity, feedback
- **When can you start?** → Immediately, notice, flexible, realistic, professional
- **Willing to relocate?** → Yes, flexible, open, conditions, adaptable
- **Willing to travel?** → Yes, flexible, adaptable, limited, negotiable
- **Odd/brain-teaser Qs (e.g., tennis balls)** → Logical, structured, creative, calm, reasoning
- **What do you know about the company?** → Research, mission, projects, values, culture

Activity

- **Students split into small groups (3–4 people, depending on number)**
- **Each group chooses a “recruiter” and “candidate” role (rotate after each round)**
- **Observers take notes**

Debrief:

- What did recruiters find convincing?
- How did candidates feel?
- What common mistakes appeared?

Class discussion:

- Biggest lessons from recruiter role
- Strongest answers heard today
- Areas to keep improving